

Wednesday, 17 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light drizzle

23° 17°

BIRMINGHAM

Heavy drizzle

21° 16°

MANCHESTER

Light rain

20° 16°

GLASGOW

Rain

17° 13°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- A Russian warship has reportedly fired warning shots near a UK-registered yacht in the English Channel.**
The incident involved the Admiral Grigorovich, a Russian frigate operating in the Channel, and occurred after the yacht apparently drifted too close. Details are still emerging about what exactly happened.

INTERNATIONAL · UK

- The UK's defence chief has warned that British forces face significant operational cuts without more government funding.**

This comes as a former defence secretary highlighted that the nation's adversaries don't adhere to Treasury timetables. The warning suggests potential impacts on the UK's military capabilities.

DEFENCE · UK

- Thames Water is moving closer to potential nationalisation after the government rejected its rescue deal.**
The Environment Secretary stated the proposed deal didn't do enough for consumers or the environment. This decision puts the future of the beleaguered water company in serious doubt.

BUSINESS · UK

- Three people have been arrested following the seizure of a record-breaking £139 million worth of cannabis in the UK.**

The massive haul, which was shipped from Canada, is one of the largest drug seizures in British history. The arrests were made in South Wales as part of the ongoing investigation.

CRIME · UK

- A jury has been told that sex abuse allegations against Sir Jeffrey Donaldson can no longer be 'brushed under the carpet'.**

The former Democratic Unionist Party leader is currently on trial facing 18 charges, including one count of rape. Sir Jeffrey denies all the allegations made against him.

JUSTICE · UK

What's coming up

- 1 A West End theatre is set to be renamed in honour of the legendary Dame Judi Dench.**

The Shaftesbury Theatre will soon bear her name, celebrating her incredible contribution to the performing arts. It's a wonderful tribute to one of Britain's most beloved actresses.

ON AIR – Isn't it fantastic to see such an iconic British talent honoured in this way? What's your favourite Dame Judi Dench performance?

THEATRE · COMING UP
- 2 Everyone's favourite bear is heading to Broadway, as a Paddington musical is set for its New York debut!**

The production will launch in the US at the AI Hirschfeld Theatre in March 2027. It sounds like a delightful new adventure for Paddington, and a chance for American audiences to enjoy his charm.

ON AIR – A Paddington musical on Broadway! Do you think he'll be bringing marmalade sandwiches to New York?

MUSICAL · 2027
- 3 Oscar-winning actress Cate Blanchett is set to become a visiting professor at Oxford University.**

She will take up the role of Visiting Professor of Contemporary Theatre at St Catherine's College. It's an exciting opportunity for students to learn from one of the world's most respected performers.

ON AIR – Imagine having Cate Blanchett as your professor! What advice do you think she'll be giving to aspiring actors?

EDUCATION · COMING UP
- 4 The Grammy Awards are expanding, with new categories for Asian Pop and Latin song added to the prestigious ceremony.**

This move comes after the growing global success of artists like Bad Bunny and KPop Demon Hunters. It reflects the changing landscape of popular music and wider recognition for diverse genres.

ON AIR – More categories at the Grammys – do you think this is a good way to celebrate the huge variety of music we're hearing today?

AWARDS · COMING UP
- 5 Singer-songwriter Myles Smith has revealed his debut album is inspired by five years of therapy notes.**

His first collection of songs draws on the personal experiences that shaped him before he found fame. It sounds like it will be a deeply personal and honest album for fans to connect with.

ON AIR – Using therapy notes for a debut album – what a unique and brave approach! Do you think personal stories make for the best music?

MUSIC · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **Chelsea defender Trevoh Chalobah has been called up to England's World Cup squad, replacing the injured Tino Livramento.**

Newcastle United full-back Livramento is unfortunately out of the campaign due to a calf injury. Chalobah's inclusion will provide Gareth Southgate with another defensive option for the tournament.

ON AIR – It's always tough to see a player miss out through injury, but a big opportunity for Chalobah! Do you think he's the right choice?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **England cricketer James Rew is set to make his Test debut, as Jamie Smith misses the second Test against New Zealand.**

Smith is absent following the birth of his daughter, opening the door for Rew to step up. He becomes the third debutant for England in this series, a big moment for the young player.

ON AIR – A debut for James Rew in the Test match – fantastic news for him! Do you think England are right to keep bringing in new talent?

CRICKET · UK

3 **Tennis legends Serena and Venus Williams are set to play together at Wimbledon once again.**

Serena has been granted a wildcard to team up with her older sister in the women's doubles. It will be exciting to see the iconic duo back on court together at the prestigious tournament.

ON AIR – The Williams sisters back together at Wimbledon! What's your favourite memory of them playing doubles?

TENNIS · UK

4 **British teenager Hannah Klugman has secured her first ever win on the WTA Tour at the Nottingham Open.**

The 17-year-old swept aside compatriot Harriet Dart in an impressive performance. It marks a significant milestone in the promising young player's career.

ON AIR – A first WTA Tour win for a British teenager – how exciting! Could Hannah Klugman be the next big name in British tennis?

TENNIS · UK

5 **Bow Echo has remained unbeaten after edging a thrilling win at Royal Ascot, taking the St James's Palace Stakes.**

The horse held off Gstaad in a grandstand finish, delighting racegoers. It was another highlight from the prestigious racing festival.

ON AIR – Royal Ascot always delivers drama! What's been your favourite moment from the racing this week?

HORSE RACING · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees garden sheds transformed into luxurious home offices and creative retreats.**
No longer just for tools, these 'shed-quarters' are being kitted out with heating, Wi-Fi, and stylish decor, offering a peaceful escape from the main house.
- 2 The joy of 'porch parcels' is on the rise, with neighbours sharing excess garden produce and homemade treats.**
It's a delightful way to build community spirit, leaving small gifts for others to discover and enjoy, fostering a real sense of connection.
- 3 Research highlights the surprising benefits of 'daydreaming' for problem-solving and creativity.**
Allowing your mind to wander can actually help connect disparate ideas, leading to innovative solutions and fresh perspectives on everyday challenges.
- 4 The simple pleasure of 'window bird watching' is becoming a popular mindfulness activity.**
Setting up a bird feeder and taking a few moments each day to observe feathered friends can be incredibly calming and a lovely way to connect with nature from home.
- 5 There's a growing appreciation for 'slow travel', focusing on enjoying the journey rather than just the destination.**
This approach encourages exploring local areas, using public transport, and savouring cultural experiences, rather than rushing from one famous landmark to another.
- 6 The humble 'board game night' is experiencing a resurgence, bringing families and friends together for unplugged fun.**
Away from screens, these evenings offer laughter, friendly competition, and quality time, proving that classic entertainment never goes out of style.
- 7 A report reveals that many people are finding joy in 'micro-gardening' – cultivating plants in small spaces like windowsills and balconies.**
Even a tiny urban dwelling can become a green oasis, offering the therapeutic benefits of gardening without needing a large outdoor plot.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'tidying' what in a restaurant, even if it's not our table?

ANSWER: THE CONDIMENT BOTTLES AND SALT AND PEPPER SHAKERS!

Q A recent poll asked Brits what small, everyday 'discovery' instantly brightens their day. What came out on top?

ANSWER: FINDING A FORGOTTEN TEN-POUND NOTE IN AN OLD COAT POCKET!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'sound' just instantly makes you feel calm, or happy, or nostalgic?**
Is there a specific everyday sound – maybe the kettle boiling, rain on the window, or a certain piece of music – that just always puts a smile on your face or brings back a lovely memory? Give us a call!

- **We all have those little 'traditions' we stick to, especially when the weather starts to improve, don't we?**
Whether it's a specific walk you always take, a favourite ice cream you buy, or a particular activity you do when the sun shines, what's your go-to 'warm weather' tradition? Let us know!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a parliament.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Baby puffins are called pufflings.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£4.75 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£4.75 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The world's smallest chameleon can fit on the tip of your finger.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time: one hundredth of a second.
- Fingernails grow faster than toenails.
- The inventor of the frisbee was turned into a frisbee after he died.
- Sea otters hold hands when they sleep so they don't drift away from each other.
- The average person walks the equivalent of three times around the world in their lifetime.
- Strawberries are the only fruit with seeds on the outside.

On this day

Day 168 of the year, 197 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Albert Chmielowski; Christian feast day: Botolph (England and Scandinavia); Christian feast day: Gondulphus of Berry; Christian feast day: Hervé. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 2000 — Odessa A'zion, American actress
- 1957 — Philip Chevron, Irish singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2013)
- 1966 — Jason Patric, American actor
- 1960 — Thomas Haden Church, American actor
- 1982 — Arthur Darvill, English actor
- 1990 — Jordan Henderson, English footballer
- 1976 — Scott Adkins, English actor and martial artist
- 1937 — Peter Fitzgerald, Irish footballer and manager (died 2013)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1940 — World War II: The British Army's 11th Hussars assault and take Fort Capuzzo in Libya from Italian forces.
- 1987 — With the death of the last individual of the species, the dusky seaside sparrow becomes extinct.
- 1948 — United Air Lines Flight 624, a Douglas DC-6, crashes near Mount Carmel, Pennsylvania, killing all 43 people on board.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1991 — Apartheid: The South African Parliament repeals the Population Registration Act which required racial classification of all South Africans at birth.
- 1940 — World War II: RMS Lancastria is attacked and sunk by the Luftwaffe near Saint-Nazaire, France. At least 3,000 are killed in Britain's worst maritime disaster.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1960 — The Nez Perce tribe is awarded \$4 million for 7 million acres (28,000 km²) of land undervalued at four cents/acre in the 1863 treaty.
- 1944 — Iceland declares independence from Denmark and becomes a republic.

- 1939 — Last public guillotining in France: Eugen Weidmann, a convicted murderer, is executed in Versailles outside the Saint-Pierre prison.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 169 of the year, 196 days left in 2026. Today Autistic Pride Day (International); Christian feast day: Bernard Mizeki (Anglican and Episcopal Church); Christian feast day: Elisabeth of Schönau; Christian feast day: Gregorio Barbarigo. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1994 — Takeoff, American rapper (died 2022)
- 1963 — Dizzy Reed, American keyboard player and songwriter
- 1925 — Robert Beadell, American composer and educator (died 1994)
- 1952 — Carol Kane, American actress
- 1950 — Jackie Leven, Scottish singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2011)
- 1942 — Carl Radle, American bass player and producer (died 1980)
- 1952 — Isabella Rossellini, Italian actress, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1933 — Tommy Hunt, American singer (died 2025)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1982 — Italian banker Roberto Calvi's body is discovered hanging beneath Blackfriars Bridge in London, England.
- 1972 — Staines air disaster: One hundred eighteen people are killed when a BEA H.S. Trident crashes minutes after takeoff from London's Heathrow Airport.
- 1940 — The "Finest Hour" speech is delivered by Winston Churchill.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1953 — A United States Air Force C-124 crashes and burns near Tachikawa, Japan, killing 129.
- 1982 — Italian banker Roberto Calvi's body is discovered hanging beneath Blackfriars Bridge in London, England.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026

FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026

WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)